



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

You should always knock on wood.



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How often does your family get together?
- Have you ever been in a car accident?
If yes, what happened?

Can Do Statements

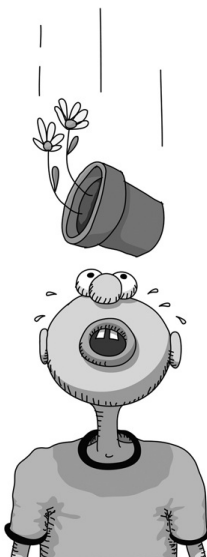
- I can talk about manners, customs and superstitions.
- I can talk about things I am supposed to do and things that are supposed to happen.
- I can talk about my attitudes toward an action.





Let's Explore!

Sally blogs about the number 13. What do hit-and-runs and the number 13 have in common?



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Tim from Toronto wants to know, "why are we supposed to knock on wood after we say something good happened to us?"

Acknowledging luck and wanting to keep it going is the easy explanation behind the superstition of knocking on wood, but there is another story.

This story involves me five years ago at my aunt and uncle's wedding anniversary. The conversation had turned to cars and eventually to car accidents. My family members all recalled being in car accidents and when I mentioned not having an accident, they all exclaimed I better knock on wood. I laughed and refused to knock on anything wooden, despite the warnings of my aunt and uncle because I wasn't superstitious ... yet.

Anyway, after all of the presents were opened and after the cake was eaten, it was time to go home. I walked down the street to get in my car and drive home, but what I found was shocking. My car had been destroyed by someone who hit it and then drove off. The door was smashed. The window was broken and the side mirror was completely torn off. In my country, if you damage another person's car you are supposed to stay and wait. At the very least, you are supposed to leave a note with a phone number. I was a victim of a hit-and-run.

So after that night, I always make sure to knock on wood.





Let's Practice!

Tim is using his passive voice to tell you about things.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Select the correct answer. Read them aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. We left after all of the presents were _____.
(opening / opened / open)
2. After the cake was _____, it was time to go home.
(eat / eaten / eating)
3. The door was _____.
(smash / smashed / smashing)
4. The window was _____.
(broke / broken / break)
5. The side mirror was completely _____ off.
(torn / tore / tear)



Let's Practice!

Tim shares his views on accidents and superstitions.

Instructions: Choose the words from the word bank to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

- to find
- Acknowledge
- to stay
- staying
- Hearing
- Acknowledging
- to have
- having

1. It was shocking _____ out about the car accident yesterday.
2. If you damage another person's car you are supposed _____ until the owner comes back.
3. When I mentioned not _____ an accident, they all said that I'd better knock on wood.
4. _____ luck is the easy explanation behind many superstitions.
5. _____ stories about bad luck always makes me think that it will happen to me.





Extension Activity

Good luck vs. Bad luck.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- With a partner, research on the Internet five expressions, phrases or idioms for good luck.
- Do the same for bad luck.
- Pick the best three and be able to explain their meanings clearly.
- Change partners.
- Teach your new partner your three good and bad luck expressions and have him/her teach you theirs.
- Change partners with other class members 2 more times.
- Return to your original partner and compare your new vocabulary.
- Make a list: good expressions on the left, bad on the right.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about manners, customs and superstitions.

☐ ☐

I talk about things I am supposed to do and things that are supposed to happen.

☐ ☐

I talk about my attitudes toward an action.

☐ ☐

I research vocabulary.

☐ ☐

I share information clearly.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to acknowledge** (verb): to say that you accept or do not deny the truth or existence of something
e.g. He had to acknowledge that it could be luck.
- eventually** (adverb): at some later time; in the end
e.g. The conversation had turned to cars and eventually to car accidents.
- to exclaim** (verb): to cry out or speak suddenly or with strong feeling
e.g. They all exclaimed that I better knock on wood.
- despite** (preposition): in spite of; notwithstanding
e.g. I refused to knock on anything wooden, despite the warnings of my aunt.
- destroyed** (adjective): broken beyond repair
e.g. My car had been destroyed by someone who hit it and then drove off.
- to drive off** (verb): if a vehicle or driver drives off, the vehicle starts moving and leaves
e.g. After he hit my car, the driver started to drive off.
- victim** (noun): someone or something that is harmed by an unpleasant event (such as an illness or accident)
e.g. I was a victim of a hit-and-run.
- hit-and-run** (noun): involving a driver who does not stop after causing an accident
e.g. My car was really damaged because of the hit-and-run.





Learning Points

Gerunds and Infinitives

A **gerund** is a verb ending with -ing (doing).

An **infinitive** is to + verb (to do).

There are rules about which verbs you can use with gerunds and which verbs you can use with infinitives. Also, the gerund can be used as the subject of the sentence.

Verbs commonly followed by a gerund:

Verbs that express **likes/dislikes**: *like, love, enjoy, hate*

Example: *I **like going** to my family parties.*

**like/love/hate* can also be followed by an infinitive.

These are some verbs that are followed by an infinitive: *hope, seem, decide, start*

Example: *I **started to walk** towards my car when the accident happened.*

You use infinitives after adjectives. Example:

*I **was very upset to see** that my car had been hit.*

An activity can be expressed as a gerund and function as the subject of the sentence.

Example:

Getting together with family is always fun.

Knocking on wood is a good idea.

Examples:

- *I wanted to keep my luck going.*
- *I mentioned not having an accident.*
- *My family members all recalled being in car accidents.*
- *I laughed and refused to knock on anything wooden.*





Learning Points

Be Supposed to

You use the structure **be supposed to** when you want to talk about expectations, obligations or arrangements.

You can use **be supposed to** to talk about situations in the past, present or future.

The structure is:

subject + to be + supposed to + verb

*You **are not supposed to** drive away from an accident.*

*You **were supposed to** leave a note.*

****Pronunciation tip**:**

When you say be supposed to, you link the /d/ and /t/ sounds together.

Like this:

Be suppose_to

Examples:

- *You are supposed to stay and wait.*
- *You are supposed to leave a note with a phone number.*

